



1000-18 (C&E Branch Secretariat)

April 2016

Distribution List

COMMUNICATIONS AND ELECTRONICS
BRANCH ADVISORY COMMITTEE (BAC) MEETING
MINUTES – THURS, 07 APRIL 2016, ADM(IM) CONF RM (8CBS S001)

RECORD OF DISCUSSIONS			
In Attendance	Rank	Name	Organization
Chairman	MGen	G.D. Loos	Branch Leader
Co-Chairman	Col	P.C. Sabourin	Branch Advisor
Members	BGen (Ret'd)	W.S. Richard	Col-Cmdt
	BGen	P. Rutherford	DGIMO
	Col	T.S. Sullivan	Dir Sigs/DLCI/Army G6
	Col	J.P.E. Charron	CELE (Air) Trade Advisor Rep
	Maj	B.M.J. Allaire	A/Cmdt CFSCE
	LCol	J.P.P. Ouellet	CANSOFCOM J6
	CWO	M.C. Boislard	Branch CWO
	MWO	P.W. Dooley	A/SCWO CFSCE
	CWO	N.J. Dubois	ATIS Tech Trade Advisor Rep
	CWO	J.E.P. Richer	ACISS Trade Advisor
New Br Adj	Maj	J.G.S Lavoie	C&E Branch Adj (1 May 16)
Branch Adj	Maj	R.R. Kollman	C&E Branch Adj
EA COS (IM)	Maj	S.A. Nickerson	EA COS (IM)
Secretary	2Lt	A. Malik	C&E Branch Asst Adj
Absent	BGen	J.J.M. Girard	DGMS
	BGen	R.G. Mazzolin	USCYBERCOM V/J7
	BGen	F.J. Allen	DG Cyber
	Col	J.C.F Beaupre	CELE (Air) Trade Advisor
	Col	S.M. Moritsugu	Comd CFIOG
	CWO	W.T. Hildreth	Comm Rsch Trade Advisor Rep

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ITEM	DISCUSSION & ACTION ITEM(S)	ACTION
I	<u>Introductory Remarks</u> 1. Opening Remarks by MGen Loos. a. Welcomed all members to his second BAC mtg.	
II	<u>Review of Action Items</u> 1. Action items from previous BAC mtg (24 September 15) were reviewed by Col Sabourin. a. (1006-03:23) The first C&E Heritage Philanthropy Leadership Award was presented at the Museum extension opening. The intent is to have one committee consider all angles and come up with all the nomination criteria before choosing candidates. It will be necessary to consider people who are leading projects, have contributed towards branch funds, various history projects, etc. b. Action Item #1: MGen Loos will engage the head of the Museum Foundation to clarify the selection process for those that are nominated for the award. c. (1006-06:10) There is some progress in the marketing of the S2S book. However, few people know about the S2S book. No answer yet as to how to close the bridge between the value of the book and the allocation of public funds towards mementos. This also includes the price being charged by the museum for the book. d. (1006-07:49) Idea of pushing the book through CFSCE during different courses as a sales strategy could be looked into. Another idea could be to present the book to the top candidate of each course. It is necessary to reach out to branch mbrs that are not in Kingston and the NCR region. It was recommended that all C&E officers should hold a copy in their office.	Col Sabourin Info (Branch Advisor) MGen Loos (Branch Leader)
III	<u>Branch Update</u> 1. (1006-11:05) Col Sabourin mentioned that a call letter will be sent out for nominations to units defining the eligibility criteria for Bursary awards. Eligibility criteria now includes members who passed away in the Line of Duty, as well as veterans and anyone whom contributes to the Museum foundation. Col Sabourin mentioned that the intent of the branch is to include all awards that are available through the branch. The call letter to unit leadership for nominations towards branch awards should include all of the available awards in order to better determine who deserves the proper award.	

	a. (1006-13:10) MGen Loos inquired, if the family of a member lost in the Line of Duty is eligible for bursary consideration? The Col Cmdt (CFSCE) mentioned that the family of fallen soldiers does get consideration for the bursary, regardless of their contribution to the Museum Foundation. Action Item #2 : Col-Cmdt will look into as to how to get the bursary information across to the families of fallen soldiers by re-establishing contact with them through the branch list (s). 2. (1006-16:10) Col Cmdt mentioned that it is necessary that the branch should be proactive and reach out to fallen soldier's families, as these families should be made aware of services available to them through the branch. CMCEN is already being used for branch awareness but the unit leadership should also reach out to the families to point out the availability of such resources in terms of bursaries, awards etc. 3. (1006-22:45) BAC members supported the nomination of Maj (Ret'd) Mike Denoble for Col-in-Chief Commendation for his 10 years of work as the C&E Museum Director. A decision was taken to award him with this commendation, and a letter was sent to Buckingham Palace for signature. The venue to hand out the award is being looked into. The announcement will be made during his luncheon. MGen Loos will not be able to make the event as he will be out of the country. 4. (1006-26:55) CWO Boislard mentioned that the current seat allocation for Commemorative Battlefield Study Tour is divided among various units. Noting that no units, including reserves, who requested seats were turned down. Two seats are being saved for the Member of the Year and the Subaltern of the Year. Branch will pay for their expenses, but not for the personal expenses. a. Currently there is no command team in place to organize or coordinate two buses. No seats are available for them, however CFSCE is willing to provide such a team. b. (1006-31:32) Col-Cmdt mentioned the availability of branch personnel (Col Schwab) on the ground. This opportunity could be used towards providing vehicles or they could be present in an official capacity. c. Proposal by CWO Boislard is that if CFSCE is willing to provide the command team, then two designated members should be funded via TD. Col Cmdt mentioned, if necessary, there should be enough funding to cover for two extra members but the issue was aval bus seats and accn.	BGen Richard (Ret'd) (Col Cmdt) CWO Boislard Info (Branch Chief)
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	5. (1006-30:28) MGen Loos mentioned that the tour is being done internally and is outside the public space, and that there will be things that we will try to do that are public events. He inquired about the CJOC's status with Op Distinction. Branch Chief mentioned that the CJOC could be re-approached regarding the draft order of personnel requirement. a. (1006-33:44) Branch leader, as a backup plan, also wants to double up the efforts to get the distinguished force identified, and proposed that we need a Value Case. Value Case could have a presence and value, in a way that is outside of public funds, while the public cost can cover for people who will provide the command role amongst our junior members. 6. (1006-42:38) CWO Boislard reviewed recent branch visits. Incl visits to Greenwood, Edmonton and Cold Lake. Col Sabourin visited Greenwood where he delivered a branch briefing on cyber force development. In March, the Col-Cmdt and Branch Chief visited units in Edmonton and Cold Lake. Visits included mess dinners, lots of mbr engagements and briefings. These visits were about bringing awareness to the branch. It is important that other units don't feel left out, nor that everything about the branch is Kingston centric. The PR season is upon us and the winners of the Member and Subaltern of the Year will be picked. 7. (1006-45:03) Branch Chief indicated that upcoming events need to be sorted out. 21 EW regiment will do Change of Command in the morning while the CFSCE will do the Change of Appointment in the late afternoon on 29 Jun 16. a. (1006-46:28) MGen Loos mentioned that there is only a small event approval for that day. It will be a chance for CFB Kingston base units to enable the VCDS to both oversee and say farewell. There will be a gift put together from the branch for him. Action Item #3: MGen Loos will check with the VCDS if he would like to do a tour that day. 7. (1006-49:55) CWO Boislard mentioned complaints they were getting from people about receiving too much material from the branch. Going forward, everything including retirements, promotions, obituaries , etc...will be put on the CMCEN and the branch website. 8. (1007-03:01) Col Sabourin proposed that event requests for C&E Week 2016 by the CA, RCAF and the Branch will be separate.	MGen Loos (Branch Leader)
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	9. (1007-04:30) Col Sullivan mentioned that the reservists can be in Kingston from Thursday till Saturday for the mess dinner events. a. (05:52) Col Sullivan proposed to have a session for all of the Honorary Colonels sometime during C&E week.	
III	<u>Col Cmdt Update</u> 1. (1006-17:24) Col-Cmdt acknowledged the good work done by the Branch Adjt on live streaming the C&E Branch Update activity, incl segmented video uploads to CMCEN as a great success. It would be highly beneficial to continue to do that in order to be visible to members all over the country. MGen Loos also declared the effort as a success, and encouraged the continuity of online efforts by the branch. a. (1006-18:28) Col Sabourin mentioned that the language used during such activities should be similar to the one used for media briefings. 2. (1006-21:30) Col Sabourin indicated that individual medallions will be issued out to all those involved in Col-in-Chief commendation instead of group medallions (S2S). Previously, while getting the commendation, group nominations were given and the group recognized but did not receive the medallion individually. Action Item #4: Col Sabourin will find an appropriate venue to conduct the ceremony of handing out indiv medallions on 29 Jun 16. 3. (1006-34:24) Col Sullivan questioned if the soldiers will be on leave during the study tour, and how payment to reservists for participating while in uniform will work. a. Col-Cmdt mentioned that mbrs could be put on some kind of official status. He is hoping that the COs will authorize this tour for the deserving members. Action Item #5 : Branch Leader's intent is to go at the working level and talk to someone in CJOC to work out any sticky issues by the end of this month. He wants to know what is being done from the event's perspective. Also, to work out any trivial issues, incl admin or other items that are needed to be taken up at higher levels. 4. (1006-38:45) BGen Rutherford inquired if there is any flexibility when it comes to rebalancing the number of people picked for the study tour from each unit. a. Col-Cmdt mentioned that if vacancies can't be filled, it could	BGen Richard Info (Ret'd) (Col Cmdt) Col Sabourin (Branch Advisor) MGen Loos (Branch Leader)

	require giving up a spot or two. This, however, would be a last resort. 5. (1006-55:11) Col-Cmdt inquired about the communication between the branch and our community moving forward. He mentioned about the availability of multiple websites such as CMCEN.ca, the Museum website and the Semaphore to Satellite website. However, CMCEN is only supported by the volunteers. Also, the newsletters from the RCAF and the Branch are no longer available in hard copy. He also mentioned that the CMCEN can help other units maintain their webpages. He urged the branch to consider looking at the current requirements to maintain communication across the entire community. a. (57:34) CWO Dubois mentioned that if nobody is paid to look after the CMCEN website, it might crash. He is getting good reviews about the ATIS and CELE trade newsletter that he sends out regularly. b. (58:29) Branch Leader suggested that an example of figuring out a way to fix things could be to solve issues such as what we have, what do we need, where we spend money and how much money we have. A better job can be done towards improving CMCEN and to investigate how it will face the test of times. Col-Cmdt offered that individual event management should be made possible through the CMCEN website. If there is an interface available, then it will become easy to figure out the simplest of things such as the presence of people at an event, parade or a dinner in example. 6. (1007-06:20) Col-Cmdt mentioned about the presence of the branch among the retired/veteran community and associates. He mentioned the outstanding work of Ret'd BGen Kevin O'Keefe. An example was that of a lineman, where the surgery he needed was only available in California and OHIP was going to cover only a part of the cost. The personnel support organization and the lineman association raised funds and helped the family out. 7. (1007-09:05) Col-Cmdt recommended the need to recognize people who are taking actions on heritage initiatives and projects. Projects such as CFSCE history and the History of Rawanda are currently underway. He recommended that a heritage category be created in the branch awards to recognize teams, units and individuals working towards heritage initiatives. a. Col Sabourin suggested that the committee deciding on heritage awards could be extended to the members of the association rather than just the BAC committee. MGen Loos suggested having the possibility of implicit and explicit committees which can have a conduit to the retired community.	
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	8. (1007-12:58) Col-Cmdt gave an update on the fundraising for Commemorative Battlefield Study Tour. He is working with the units. \$250K is the initial target for fundraising. \$5K per member is the estimation. Hope is to collect \$1500 per member from natl fundraising, \$3000 from the mbr units sponsoring, and \$500 will be out of member's own pocket for travel insurance, personal expenses, dinner meals etc. a. Col-Cmdt mentioned that the projection of fundraising going forward will be about the board and the recognition of deserving high performers from each unit. It should showcase the fundraising under an authorized charitable organization. 9. (1007-25:32) Col-Cmdt briefed BAC about the efforts to help the retirees with a smooth transition. The effort is there to reach out to the veterans and have them stay connected to the branch especially through the CMCEN. This way they can get information about employment after retirement and can get a CMCEN.ca email account to stay abreast of the latest news or avail sp. 10. (1007-27:50) Col-Cmdt mentioned the Hill 70 battle. The objective was to find out if the branch will do a presentation about this exclusive Canadian battle to recognize the family members sacrificed at Hill 70. The branch has been asked if it wants to be a part of the memorial of this monument. A plaque will be unveiled later, but there is a cost associated with it. Action Item #6: Decision on this issue to be taken up in the next BAC meeting. (1007-31:12 & 32:40) MGen Loos confirmed that the money would come from the foundation if the plan goes through. It is important to be a part of the history, and this is the reason why members are being sent to the tour, therefore being part of the Hill 70 will make sense. 11. (1007-34:52) Col-Cmdt brought up the point of initiatives to recognize the members that have passed away. There was a mention of naming a building after General Ramsey Withers. Signal squadron in Valcartier has a building named after him. The suggestion was that the unit could do something similar in the future. a. Next point was the initiative to recognize BGen Don Banks (deceased). As one of only a few officers who went from a Private on to become a General Officer. The question was if the branch would entertain the idea of having his resume on a plaque in the museum if the Heritage committee asks? Col-Cmdt suggested to set the precedent if a similar situation arises again.	MGen Loos (Branch Leader)
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	b. (41:35) The Branch Leader mentioned branch interest in naming buildings after members. He mentioned the importance of people to the branch, and that the branch could advocate for naming the buildings. However, this could be a Chain of Command issue. Action Item #7 : MGen Loos will engage ADM (IE) regarding naming the building after a member.	MGen Loos (Branch Leader)
IV	<u>C&E Week Update</u> 1. (1007-00:00) Br Adjt provided an update of the C&E Garrison Military Band situation. He mentioned that the Branch should take any opportunity possible to reinforce its appreciation of these volunteers, as the band is requested to play at numerous events and their efforts are always well respected. If possible, the Base should be approached to provide for their transportation requirements. 2. A quick review of the draft copy of the schedule of the C&E Week 2016 events was provided. This has now been handed over to the incoming Br Adjt team (Maj Steeve Lavoie/Lt Jonathan Farlam).	Maj Kollman Info (Br Adjt)
V	<u>Home Station & Museum CO Update</u> 2. (1008-00:00) Maj Allaire (on behalf of the Home Station CO) briefed the BAC on activities occurring at the Home Station. a. Mike Denoble, the Museum Director is leaving after serving for 10 years in the job. Karen Young will be the new Museum Manager. His outgoing ceremony will be on the 22nd April 2016, 1300-1400. b. (01:20) Karen Young has lots of experience with public museums. One of her initiatives is to change the museum opening hours in order to provide some downtime for the staff to do some necessary admin and to align it better with other museums. LCol Lemieux will send out the new timings after considering all the questions and concerns. c. Vimy activities will take place in Kingston from the Home Station perspective. More to follow from the school Chief. d. Annual hockey tournament update, CFSCE vs RCEME school. After many years of trying, CFSCE won the tournament.	LCol Lemieux Info (Home Station CO)

	e. (08:10)Branch Curling Bonspiel took place in February 2016 and went well. Sgt. Stadnichuk did an outstanding job of organizing the event. He recommended through the after action report that the event be held during the C&E Week. That way the participation number can go higher because in February time period, the school is usually busy with courses. f. Golf Tournament is scheduled for 18– 19 Aug 16. Sgt. Sibley has already started the planning process, and is trying to market it to get more participation. g. BCAOC mess dinner is scheduled for 11 May 16. CFSCE mess dinner is scheduled for 26 May 16, potentially moving that to June. h. Maj Allaire brought up the point of formalizing the head of the band and mentioned the importance of the band. Discussion needs to be there in order to solve the financial resources issue for the band. MGen Loos mentioned that anything he can do from his side such as meeting with CADTC or the Base Commander, he will do in order to aid in resolving any issues.	
VI	<u>Environment Updates/Issues</u> 1. RCAF Trade Adv updated the BAC regarding CELE (Air) Officers. a. (1008 - 24:45) He mentioned about the upcoming TP writing Board in Trenton 9–20 May 16. LCol Mitchell Lavoie, 22 Wing WATSO will chair the board. The course is being re-branded as Air OPS C4ISR in order to meet the objective of where the branch and Air Force is heading in moving forward. b. (25:15) BCAOC graduation is coming up on 11 May 16. Expectation is that 21 officers will graduate, one of the biggest numbers in a while. It is a new course. The course just spent two weeks dealing with the Cyber objective which is a brand new aspect brought in this year. The reduction in attrition is coming from the new OJT package which was re-inserted as a pre-requisite. Also, candidates spent most of the OJT time with tactical units in order to get the exposure. c. (26:10) CELE Air has the lowest attrition rate among all trades. However, there is a hard push in place for succession planning. d. (26:57) Only 2 expected LCol promotions will take place which is the lowest number for promotions. There will be 12 promotions to Major. This brings the PML to 88% which is lowest overall. After this year's BCAOC course inject, there will be a shortage of 16 Captains and 11 Majors.	Colonel Charron Info (CELE (Air) Trade Advisor Rep)

	e. (27:54) Functional wing alignment took place in Trenton. WTIS will be cut over to the operational support squadrons. Effective this summer, trial wings are 17 Wing and 9 Wing. Expectation is that by 2017 rest of the Wings will be cut over. The LOG branch is freeing up the Wing Admin position which will be rebranded as a Deputy Wing Commander. Suggestions for this idea have been passed over to the Commander 1CAD and the RCAF Commander. f. (28:47) CELE (Air) LCol, might get the consideration as an OSS. OSSO (currently known as WOPSO) might be taken back by Col Frawley to get some traction. Deputy Wing Comd Cathy Blue, who was one of the reps promoted the strong footprint of CELE(Air) in Trenton to help 8 Wing get the preferential consideration for Deputy Wing Comd. (i) (29:28) The Branch Leader mentioned having talks at the higher level on this issue. The Air Force is on the path of evolution. The plan is to start with the functions and capabilities that contributes to the success of Air space power. It is important to have the recognition that it is more than just providing the human power to fuel the planes. It could be also about the Cyber domain, C4ISR and systems to systems. The Air Force community also has a leading role and this is why the move from WTIS from underneath roads and grounds maintenance over to operations to be the C4ISR, the right hand man of the Commander. However, this will occur over time. The Branch Leader also suggested looking at the succession planning in order to have people that are technically smart and more operationally aware. g. (1008-32:25) Col Charron inquired about the positions that will go vacant. The request was if as a branch we can get some direction over what are the priority trades and jobs we should be going after. Also, where should the hit for vacancies to put people MMO be taken? In addition, there was a question regarding the LCol grievances, whether to review non-traditional positions if there is a command component to it. An example was that of someone going to the Defense Attache Assistant position which is hurting the IM group. These questions need to be addressed as they come up at succession planning boards. (i) (1008-34:00) MGen Loos mentioned that the point is well taken but he does not know what the potential answer looks like in managing the issue as well as reinforcing the key investments.	
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	h. (1008-37:49) Col Charron updated BAC about various events. There was a mention of annual RF conference being held in Kingston. All 3 environments were present along with the vendors. PD aspect re-energizing the legacy equipment including HF connecting to IP networks. (i) (1008-38:36) Lineman conference went well. Linemen were as engaged and vocal as ever, and showed solidarity. (ii) (1008-39:00) Line Chief advisor position was discussed. The positions still sits in RCAF. Currently, looking at re-establishing a position in IM group as a Senior Advisor working with Directorate of Chief. The plan is to bring back the go to person for LST function, not to trump the ACISS CWO but to bring the go to person for technical authority for safety and working in confined space. 3. (1007-14:33) RCCS Dir updated the BAC for ACCIS. a. Overall morale is that of frustration. Mainly, frustration over the transition to ACCIS and the pay review hasn't gone through. b. Spec pay is being delayed. DPPD stopped pay reviews because they were retooling pay review system. LCIS techs are most affected by this. The Commander of the Army has pushed it through to the CDS to rescind the decision and provide the backpay especially to all those LCIS techs who are affected by this. c. Another issue was that of the school struggling to train the ACCIS group. They are conducting the job based analysis in order to give clear direction to the soldiers as to what the job demands/description are. 4. (1007-19:18) RCCS Dir updated the BAC for Sigs Officers. a. There is no establishment plan for the regular force. There have been demand signals from the Cyber and the IM groups. The supply signal recommendation from the CFD are the distressed trades. They are proposing that ACCIS techs and Signal officers be the targets. 13 Signal positions and 83 ACCIS positions are recommended for divestment to provide for the new positions. Signal officers are in distress for last 3 years. Challenge with the ACCIS trade is that they are 300 shy of the limit but at the Private or Corporal level they are still in the ACCIS core and not in the subocs yet. Also, Officers are 20 short this year as comparison to 60 from last year. 5. (1007-22:02) RCCS updated BAC about 5 Sigs requesting the review of the translation of RCCS. The Commander sees no	Col Sullivan Info (RCCS Dir)
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	substantial reason to change it, therefore it remains the same (CTRC). 6. (1007-22:20) CDLS London has the event approval for Col-Cmdt, Col Sullivan and CWO Richer to attend the luncheon for our Honorary Capt Mrs. Langford in London. CDS will also be present.	
VI	<u>Round Table</u> 1. (1008-45:00) CWO Dubois mentioned that the MMOs will be far and few. Directive is that there will not be any MMOs if there are vacancies. (i) (1008-45:45) MGen Loos mentioned that there is an overall need for air personnel. He is willing to way in if people need to get more experience before they go do something in the institution. 3. (1008-48:01) Col Sabourin updated BAC about the Cyber trade. A recent decision to endorse the creation of new trade was taken at the Armed Forces Counsel. The Cyber trade will be located at CFNOC. Different aspects of the trade will need to be looked into. Some examples are its implementation towards the services based on the job taskings and positions within Cyber. The current plan is to have the implementation order signed before the summer with the implementation start in September. (i) (1008-50:05) The Branch Leader mentioned the progress of the Cyber trade. It is closer to beginning than the end. There is more study analysis to be done and decisions to be taken. The capability area is bigger than the Cyber operations. The message was that everybody is a part of the Cyber Operations fight even though they are not dealing with it directly. For implementation, it is important that it takes place either through voluntary occupational transfer or aptitude and interests. 7. Next BAC Mtg will take place on 22 Sep 16.	

Prepared by: Maj R. Kollman, C&E Branch Adj
Reviewed by: Col P. Sabourin, C&E Branch Advisor

Dist List

BAC Membership